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Credit: It's Not Your Money

Most people would have fatter wallets
if they removed all the credit cards.

—Ann Landers

A father once told me a story about when he gave his daughter her first credit card as she left for college. He said, "Honey, use this only if it is an emergency." She then asked what he considered an emergency. He replied, "If you can eat it, drink it, wear it, or listen to it, it's not an emergency!"

In 2006, credit card issuers mailed out nearly 8 billion U.S. solicitations, according to CardWatch. That's a 30 percent increase over the prior year. Unfortunately, these solicitations are not all thrown in the garbage or the average American wouldn't have nine credit card accounts, as reported by MyFICO. This accumulation starts young as evidenced by the fact that 50 percent of the high school seniors surveyed by the Jump\$tart Coalition in 2006 already had a credit card in their name.

How many credit cards do we need? At the most, two major credit cards. Major credit cards are now accepted almost everywhere and it's no longer necessary to have a gas card to pay for gas or a retail card to buy from a department store. By limiting the